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JS validation 15m

Checking data is essential to keeping it accurate and secure before it's added to the database. We do this first on the client side using JavaScript, and then again on the server side with a different programming language.

JavaScript is a useful tool for carrying out this validation process. For example, think about a basic registration form: if we click on the Register button at the bottom of an empty form, we expect to see some kind of warning message. Test the form below to see if it works.



The validation in the following CodePen will not run in iQualify due to iframe restrictions. To test the validation, select "Open in new tab" on "Edit on CodePen"



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HTMLCSSJS

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">

<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport"
content="width=device-width,
initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Simple Registration Form
with JS Validation</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet"
href="styles.css">
</head>

<body>
  <div class="container">
    <form id="form" class="form">
      <h2>Register With Us</h2>
      <div class="form-control">
        <label
for="username">Username</label>
        <input type="text"
id="username" placeholder="Enter
username">
        <small>Error
Message</small>
      </div>
      <div class="form-control">
        <label
for="email">Email</label>
        <input type="text"
id="email" placeholder="Enter
email">
        <small>Error
Message</small>
      </div>
      <div class="form-control">
        <label
for="password">Password</label>
        <input type="password"
id="password" placeholder="Enter
password">
        <small>Error
Message</small>
      </div>
      <div class="form-control">
        <label
for="confirm-password">Confirm Password</label>
        <input type="password"
id="confirm-password" placeholder="Enter
password again">
        <small>Error
Message</small>
      </div>
      <button type="button">Register</button>
    </form>
  </div>
</body>
</html>
```

Register With Us

Username

Email

Password

Confirm Password

Register

Resources1x0.5x0.25xRerun

Example 7.7 Validation of a registration form



Take note of the `<id>` and `class` values in Example 7.7, as these are the references used within the JavaScript.

In Example 7.7, we set up a listener on the form button to handle validation. This listener applies a set of rules whenever the button is pressed. To do this, we created several [JavaScript functions](#) that:

- Check if a field is filled in (required)
- Make sure a string is within a certain length
- Confirm if a value is a valid email address
- Compare two strings, like matching passwords

We also added features to give users feedback right away by changing the look of the form. For example, we updated the HTML and CSS dynamically to show if something is wrong. If there's an error, we also update the message in the form to explain the problem.

Validation with the F12 web developer panel

Since JavaScript is a programming language, you might need to debug your code from time to time. The F12 panel in your browser has a tab called 'Console'. This tab allows you to see JavaScript messages, notifications, errors and other useful information.

You can use the function below to send information to the console log. This is helpful when you're keeping track of variable values, incoming data or similar tasks.

```
console.log(data);
```

You might have seen this line of code in earlier AJAX examples, where it was used to observe the exchange of data during AJAX requests. You can replace the 'data' variable with any other variable you want to examine.

Let's now look at APIs.



Thoughts on this page?

